Fed Chair Warsh × IMF (Bangkok, 2026-10-16) — Post-Event Book

v20261017-0801-post | built 2026-10-17 08:01 SGT from locked pre-event book v20261015-1805 (integrity checked, not rewritten) | Not investment advice. Quotes are from press reports (no official transcript at build time).

1. What he said (FACT, press-reported) → our reading

- "I don't prejudge meetings. I don't believe in saying now what I might do at the meetings that we have in the balance of this year." — *CNBC* → neutral
- "It's a new chapter at the Fed [and] we're not in that business anymore." (on forward guidance) — *CNBC* → neutral
- "We came to a judgement" in September … "the world has broadly conformed to our expectations." — *AFP* → dovish
- Global tightening was "a synchronous tightening in monetary policy in most places around the world"; "no free riders". — *CNBC* → hawkish
- "Almost everywhere in the global economy (is) showing resilience I'm not sure I would have predicted five or six months ago." — *AFP* → hawkish
- AI: optimism "leavened by the seriousness of purpose"; the path will be "very bumpy"; near-term demand-side inflation, longer-run positive supply shock. — *CNBC* → neutral

Third-party: Goldman Sachs (Hatzius) note via CNBC: Warsh's comments, alongside other FOMC participants, "indicate that the FOMC is set to pause in October"; still expects a second and final hike in December. [CNBC] CME FedWatch 72.3% probability of no change at Oct 27–28 (CNBC, updated 10/16 08:36 ET). [CNBC] IMF MD Georgieva (same day): central banks should be "laser focused on price stability"; IMF supports the recent tightening by the Fed, ECB and BOJ; US/German/Japanese 10Y yields recently at highest since 2002/2009/1996. [IMF]

Locked-rule verdict: NEUTRAL. Opening quote is the locked neutral trigger (「不预判」) and no path guidance was given; no 'not falling clearly/fast enough' (hawk trigger) and no look-through-energy (dove trigger) language reported.

2. Market reaction

- Kalshi October 25bp hike: 0.295 before (23:29 ET) → 0.185 at 00:00 → 0.14500000000000002 at 01:00 → 0.135 at the 10/16 close. December hike ~0.775 → 0.765 (unchanged). The hike was **pushed to December, not removed**.

- 30-minute window: 2Y ≈ -2.6bp (ZT-futures estimate), USD/JPY -0.04%, NQ futures +0.33%. Buckets vs locked bands: {‘Oct odds 10 月概率 (level after)’: ‘dovish’, ‘2Y (bp, +30m)’: ‘neutral’, ‘USD/JPY (% , +30m)’: ‘neutral’, ‘NQ fut (% , +30m)’: ‘dovish’}.
- 10/16 US cash session (context, not attributable): Nasdaq -2.15%, S&P -1.09%, SOX -3.83% — AI/tech de-crowding and Brent touching $110 (AP, Yahoo Finance).

3. Calibration

Brier (outcome = neutral): OS 0.380 vs uniform 0.667 — better than uniform. Scored on the market’s read (dovish) it would be 0.980. Error class: **Market-Reaction** — our conditional note (“hot data → neutral reads hawkish”) failed; PPI was hot and retail strong, yet the market read neutral as a pause.

4. Root cause & recalibration

Twelve days before a meeting priced ~30% for a hike, a no-guidance chair’s silence is dovish for that meeting; “the world has conformed to our [September] expectations” re-endorses the September path (December). Other FOMC speakers had been preparing a pause (not summarised in our pre-book — blind spot). New Observation Zone candidate; central-bank pre-books will add an “other officials, last 2 weeks” panel and a “prior decision still valid” lexicon entry.

5. Valuation

No material company information → no valuation revisions. Rate path shifted in timing, not in total → WACC assumptions unchanged.

6. Falsifier

If the FOMC hikes on Oct 28, the market’s read (not our wording call) was wrong; this book’s “market-mapping error” stays INFERENCE until then.

Source ledger, assumption register and full teaching: see the Chinese edition §8–10.